

## Aurikrex Universal Design System

v1.0 — Brand-level reference for every Aurikrex product

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Date:</b>         | July 13, 2026                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Applies to:</b>   | Aurikrex Library, SyncGrade, CBT, Phorynt — and any future Aurikrex product                                                                                         |
| <b>Derived from:</b> | Aurikrex Library codebase audit (the only product with a mature, shipped implementation to extract from)                                                            |
| <b>Excludes:</b>     | Any pattern classified LIBRARY-SPECIFIC in the source audit — reading themes, gamification/coin economy, and other reading-app-only implementations. See Section 9. |

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**How to use this document:** these are the tokens, rules, and base components every Aurikrex product inherits. When a product needs something this document doesn't cover — a CBT question card, a SyncGrade GPA dial, a Phorynt-specific interaction — build it using the primitives below (color, type, spacing, radius, motion) rather than introducing new raw values. Document the new pattern back into that product's own extension reference once built.

# 1. Color System

## 1.1 Core Neutrals (Dark Theme — default)

| Token                  | Value              | Usage                |
|------------------------|--------------------|----------------------|
| --color-bg-primary     | #0a0a0a            | App background       |
| --color-bg-secondary   | #111111            | Secondary containers |
| --color-bg-card        | #161616            | Cards, modals        |
| --color-text-primary   | #ffffff            | Primary text         |
| --color-text-secondary | #a0a0a0            | Secondary/muted text |
| --color-text-muted     | #555555            | Disabled/muted text  |
| --color-border         | #222222            | Default borders      |
| --color-border-hover   | #333333            | Border hover state   |
| --color-overlay        | rgba(10,10,10,0.8) | Modal/dialog overlay |

## 1.2 Core Neutrals (Light Theme)

| Token                  | Value   | Usage                |
|------------------------|---------|----------------------|
| --color-bg-primary     | #f5f5f0 | App background       |
| --color-bg-secondary   | #ebebe6 | Secondary containers |
| --color-bg-card        | #ffffff | Cards, modals        |
| --color-text-primary   | #0a0a0a | Primary text         |
| --color-text-secondary | #444444 | Secondary/muted text |
| --color-text-muted     | #888888 | Disabled/muted text  |
| --color-border         | #dddddd | Default borders      |
| --color-border-hover   | #cccccc | Border hover state   |

Accent colors (below) do not change between dark and light theme — both are designed to work on either background.

## 1.3 Brand Accents

| Token                  | Value                   | Role                                                                           |
|------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| --color-accent-primary | #3b82f6 / hover #60a5fa | PRIMARY brand accent — buttons, links, active states, navigation, all standard |
| --color-accent-ai-flag | #c9a84c / hover #e0bc6a | RESERVED EXCLUSIVELY for flagging AI-generated or AI-assisted content          |
| --color-text-on-accent | #0a0a0a                 | Text color placed on top of an accent-colored background                       |

**This is a two-color brand system, deliberately.** Every other color in a product's UI should trace back to a neutral or a semantic status color below — not a third or fourth "accent" invented per product. If a product seems to need a third accent

color, that's a signal to reconsider the design, not a signal to add a token.

## 1.4 Semantic Status Colors

Resolved from the Library audit, which found five different unofficial error-red variants and two different success-green variants scattered across the codebase with no formal tokens. These three are now the only sanctioned status colors for any Aurikrex product:

| Token           | Value   | Usage                                                                 |
|-----------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| --color-error   | #ef4444 | Errors, destructive actions, validation failures, wrong answers (CBT) |
| --color-success | #22c55e | Success confirmations, correct answers (CBT), completed states        |
| --color-warning | #f59e0b | Warnings, caution states, time-running-out indicators (CBT)           |

These did not exist as formal tokens anywhere in the audited codebase — every product should define these three in its own tokens file immediately, since CBT in particular will depend heavily on error/success semantics for answer feedback.

## 2. Typography

| Token          | Font Stack                  | Weights            | Usage                                                               |
|----------------|-----------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| --font-display | 'Playfair Display', serif   | 600, 700           | Headings, logos, display text, stat values — the signature brand    |
| --font-body    | 'Inter', sans-serif         | 400, 500, 600, 700 | Body text, buttons, labels, inputs                                  |
| --font-mono    | 'JetBrains Mono', monospace | 400, 600           | Codes, badges, counters, keyboard shortcuts, tabular/numerical data |

### Type Scale (in use across Library, applicable everywhere)

| Context             | Size                       |
|---------------------|----------------------------|
| Hero headlines      | clamp(2.25rem, 5vw, 4rem)  |
| Section headings    | clamp(1.6rem, 3vw, 2.2rem) |
| Page titles         | 2rem                       |
| Card titles         | 0.95rem – 1.15rem          |
| Body / paragraph    | 0.9rem – 1.05rem           |
| Labels / small text | 0.72rem – 0.82rem          |
| Badges              | 0.65rem – 0.75rem          |
| Buttons (sm/md/lg)  | 0.85rem / 0.95rem / 1rem   |

Line-height: 1.2 for headings, 1.7 for body text.

## 3. Spacing Scale

| Token      | Value |
|------------|-------|
| --space-1  | 4px   |
| --space-2  | 8px   |
| --space-3  | 12px  |
| --space-4  | 16px  |
| --space-5  | 24px  |
| --space-6  | 32px  |
| --space-7  | 48px  |
| --space-8  | 64px  |
| --space-9  | 80px  |
| --space-10 | 96px  |

Every spacing value in any component — padding, gap, margin — should resolve to one of these ten tokens. Hardcoded pixel spacing was the single largest source of drift found in the Library audit.

## 4. Border Radius & Elevation

| Token         | Value | Usage                                                                                             |
|---------------|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| --radius-sm   | 4px   | Minimal rounding                                                                                  |
| --radius-md   | 8px   | Inputs, small cards, toasts, inline badges                                                        |
| --radius-lg   | 16px  | Main cards, modals, sections                                                                      |
| --radius-xl   | 20px  | Large hero/feature cards (formalized — was an undocumented fallback value in the source codebase) |
| --radius-pill | 999px | Buttons, badges, pills, toggles                                                                   |

**Elevation (shadow patterns in use, not yet formal tokens — recommend formalizing as --shadow-sm/md/lg per product)**

| Pattern                                      | Usage                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0 8px 24px rgba(0,0,0,0.3)                   | Card hover, toast                                              |
| 0 8px 32px rgba(0,0,0,0.28)                  | Dropdowns, floating panels                                     |
| 0 0 0 2px <accent>                           | Focus rings (see Section 7.4)                                  |
| 0 0 12px color-mix(primary 18%, transparent) | Accent glow on hover (replaces prior gold-tinted glow pattern) |

## 5. Motion & Transitions

| Token             | Value      |
|-------------------|------------|
| --transition-fast | 150ms ease |
| --transition-base | 250ms ease |

### Standard Interaction Patterns

- Button active (not disabled): transform: scale(0.97)
- Card/button hover: transform: translateY(-1px) to translateY(-4px), duration --transition-base
- Hover brightness: filter: brightness(1.05), duration --transition-base
- Scroll reveal: opacity 0→1, translateY(16–28px → 0), 400–600ms ease
- Reduced motion: honor prefers-reduced-motion by disabling all animation/transition — required on every product, not optional

## 6. Iconography

**Library:** lucide-react — standardize across all products for visual consistency and to avoid mixing icon styles.

| Context                | Size        |
|------------------------|-------------|
| Inline / toolbar icons | 18px × 18px |
| Admin nav icons        | 20px × 20px |
| Feature card icons     | 22px × 22px |

## 7. Base Component Library

These are interaction primitives found consistently enough in Library to be treated as universal. Product-specific components (see Section 9) should be built by composing these, not by inventing parallel patterns.

### 7.1 Button

| Variant   | Background             | Text                   | Border                 | Hover                                    |
|-----------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Primary   | --color-accent-primary | --color-text-on-accent | --color-accent-primary | BG → primary-hover, translateY(-1px)     |
| Secondary | transparent            | --color-accent-primary | --color-accent-primary | BG → color-mix(primary 15%, transparent) |
| Ghost     | transparent            | --color-text-secondary | transparent            | Text → --color-accent-primary            |

Active state (all variants): transform: scale(0.97). Disabled: opacity 0.7, cursor not-allowed. Sizes: sm/md/lg use font-size 0.85/0.95/1rem with --space-2–6 padding pairs.

### 7.2 Card (base pattern)

- background-color: var(--color-bg-card); border: 1px solid var(--color-border); border-radius: var(--radius-lg)
- Hover: transform: translateY(-4px); border-color: var(--color-accent-primary); transition 250ms ease

### 7.3 Badge

| Variant       | Style                                                      |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary/New   | BG --color-accent-primary, text --color-text-on-accent     |
| Info          | Border + text --color-accent-primary, transparent BG       |
| Neutral/Draft | BG --color-bg-secondary, text --color-text-muted, bordered |

### 7.4 Input — Focus State (canonical, resolved from 6 fragmented patterns found in audit)

```
border-color: var(--color-accent-primary);
box-shadow: 0 0 2px color-mix(in srgb, var(--color-accent-primary) 25%, transparent);
outline: none;
transition: border-color var(--transition-fast), box-shadow var(--transition-fast);
```

This single rule replaces every prior focus implementation. No product should introduce a new variant.

### 7.5 Toast / Notification

| Variant | Border/Accent Color                                               |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Success | color-mix(in srgb, var(--color-success) 50%, var(--color-border)) |

|       |                                                                          |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Info  | color-mix(in srgb, var(--color-accent-primary) 50%, var(--color-border)) |
| Error | var(--color-error)                                                       |

## 7.6 Toggle Switch (canonical — consolidated from 3 separate implementations found in audit)

- On-state: background var(--color-accent-primary); handle white
- Off-state: background var(--color-border); handle var(--color-text-muted)

Three separate toggle implementations existed in Library alone. Every product should implement exactly one shared Toggle component, not one per page.

## 7.7 Navigation Bar (base pattern)

- Height: 64px, fixed position
- Background: color-mix(in srgb, var(--color-bg-primary) 92%, transparent); backdrop-filter: blur(12px)
- Active link indicator: var(--color-accent-primary)

## 8. The AI-Flag Color Rule — Cross-Product Governance

This is the one rule every product must follow identically, because its entire value depends on consistency:

**--color-accent-ai-flag (gold, #c9a84c) is used only to indicate that content on screen was generated or substantially assisted by AI.** Never for decoration, never for a "premium" tier indicator, never repurposed for anything else — in any product.

The moment a student sees gold anywhere in an Aurikrex product, it should mean the same thing every time: this came from AI, not from the core curated content. This applies directly to the AI reading companion (Library), the cumulative performance review narration (CBT), and any future AI-assisted feature in SyncGrade or Phorynt.

***Current status:** no product has AI-content UI built yet, so this token is currently unused everywhere. Apply it as the very first design decision the moment any AI-generated content becomes visible in any product — do not let a product improvise its own AI-indicator color under deadline pressure.*

## 9. What This Document Does NOT Cover

This document is the honest ceiling of what could be extracted from a single shipped product. Two categories are deliberately excluded, and a third category doesn't exist yet anywhere and needs to be designed fresh, not extracted:

### 9.1 Excluded — Library-Specific Implementation

- Reader theme system (dark/sepia/white reading modes) — specific to long-form reading comfort, not a brand pattern
- Coin economy visuals (CoinBalance, CoinIcon, StreakWidget, gamification animations) — specific to Library's engagement mechanics
- Book-specific components (BookCard, ShelfBookCard, tier-access buttons)

None of these should be assumed to apply to SyncGrade or CBT just because they exist in Library.

### 9.2 Not Yet Designed — No Precedent Exists in Any Product

These will need genuine design work using the primitives above, not extraction from an existing codebase, because nothing like them has been built yet:

- CBT: question cards, answer-option selection states, countdown/timer displays, per-subtopic performance visualizations, the AI-narrated cumulative review layout
- SyncGrade: GPA/grade visualization components, institution-specific badge system
- Any product: the AI reading-companion chat interface itself (inline Q&A; pattern) — referenced in prior planning but never built

### 9.3 Recommendation

When any of the above gets designed for the first time, treat it as a new addition to this universal document if the pattern is genuinely reusable across products (e.g. a timer/countdown component could serve both CBT and a future Library reading-session feature), or as a product-specific extension document if it's genuinely one-product-only (e.g. GPA visualization is SyncGrade-only). Don't let either category default to "just build it in Figma once and never write it down" — that's how the four rogue Library pages happened in the first place.

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